



Operations Governance and Document Control

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Version: 1.0	Effective date: 2024-01-15	Access scope: all_staff
Site scope: all_sites		

NU-OPS-001 · Current
Northstar Urgent Care Cooperative · Organization-wide
Version 1.0 · Effective 2024-01-15 · Access scope: all_staff

Fictional educational test material. This document describes administrative governance for the fictional Northstar Urgent Care Cooperative (NUCC). It is not operational guidance for a real organization.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy establishes how NUCC assigns ownership, approves, reviews, and identifies controlled non-clinical operations documents. It applies to organization-wide and site-level administrative policies, procedures, checklists, and reference documents used at Harbor Point, Alder Creek, and Northgate.

This policy does not establish clinical workflows, care decisions, or requirements for external records. A document owner must route material outside non-clinical operations to the appropriate separate process; this policy does not define that process.

2. Document ownership and approval

Each controlled document must identify one accountable **owner role**. The owner is responsible for keeping the content within its stated purpose, obtaining review from affected roles, and submitting a proposed revision when the content is no longer accurate.

The Director of Operations approves organization-wide operational policies and cross-site procedures. A site lead may approve a local checklist or work aid that applies only at that site, provided it does not change an organization-wide requirement. If a proposed local practice appears to conflict with a controlled organization-wide document, staff should follow the organization-wide document and refer the conflict to the Director of Operations for resolution.

Approval is recorded in the controlled copy's revision record. A draft, working note, meeting record, or unapproved local copy does not change an approved requirement by itself.

3. Required document controls

Every controlled document must show:

- A stable document ID and descriptive title.

- An owner role and intended audience.
- Applicable site scope and access scope.
- Status and version.
- Issue and effective dates; a review date where a scheduled review applies.
- A revision record describing the change and its approval.
- Links to documents it amends, supersedes, or depends on, where applicable.

Use one version number for each approved issue. Increment the major number when purpose, scope, or a material requirement changes; increment the minor number for a clarification or non-substantive correction. The owner must describe the change in plain language. A separately issued bulletin may amend only the sections it names; all other requirements remain in force.

4. Review cycle and interim changes

The owner reviews a controlled document at least once every twelve months and sooner when a role, site arrangement, or referenced process changes. A review may confirm that no change is needed; record that decision and the next review date.

When an immediate administrative correction is needed between scheduled reviews, the owner submits a dated revision for approval. Until approval is recorded, staff should not treat a proposed edit as a new requirement. If an approved temporary exception is needed, it must identify its authorizing role, affected site and subject, start and end dates, and the base requirements it changes. Requirements outside that stated scope remain unchanged.

5. Identifying and using a controlled copy

Use the approved copy in the designated central operations document repository. Before relying on a downloaded or printed copy, check its document ID, status, version, and effective date against the repository entry. A copy marked **Draft**, **Superseded**, or **Withdrawn** is not the current approved instruction.

If the repository copy is unavailable, or two copies show different versions, do not choose between them by file timestamp or appearance. Ask the document owner or the Director of Operations to confirm the controlled copy. The role-based routing directory is maintained separately in NU-OPS-007.

6. Superseded and withdrawn copies

When a new approved version replaces a prior version, the owner marks the earlier copy **Superseded**, records the replacement ID and effective date, and removes it from locations presented as current guidance. Retain the historical copy in the designated archive for traceability. Historical copies may support questions about what applied during an earlier period; they must not be presented as current requirements.

If a document is withdrawn without replacement, mark it **Withdrawn**, record the effective date and owner, and state that no replacement is established when that is the case. Do not infer a replacement process from an archived document.

7. Access and distribution

Each document carries one of the corpus access labels defined in NU-OPS-010: `all_staff`, `site_operations`, or `operations_leads`. These labels are retrieval and distribution conventions for this fictional corpus. They do not establish real-world security controls. Owners must assign the label according to the intended audience and the access matrix; when the audience or authorization context is unclear, the owner must resolve it before wider distribution.

Do not add personal contact details or unnecessary personal information to controlled operational documents. Use role names and the current role-based directory when a routing destination is needed.

8. Revision record

Version	Issue date	Effective date	Change	Approval
1.0	2024-01-08	2024-01-15	Initial governance and document-control policy	Approved by Director of Operations on 2024-01-08

Next scheduled review: 2025-01-15.

Owner: Director of Operations, Northstar Urgent Care Cooperative.